Zhili WANG

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Education

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology — Hong Kong SAR, China
Ph.D. in Data Science and Analytics; GPA: 3.74/4.0; Supervisor: Lei CHEN — Sep. 2020 – Feb. 2025

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology — Hong Kong SAR, China
M.S. in Big Data and Technology; GPA: 3.70/4.0 — Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2020

University of Electronic Science and Technology of China — Chengdu, Sichuan, China
B.Eng. in Spatial Information and Digital Technology; GPA: 3.87/4.0 — Sep. 2015 – Jun. 2019

Research Interests

- **Quantitative Research**: Full lifecycle of systematic trading strategy development.
- **Cutting-edge AI Research**: LLM attention; Neural architecture search for DL models; relational modeling; etc.

Publications

- **Zhili Wang**, Shimin Di, Lei Chen, Xiaofang Zhou. *Search to Fine-tune Pre-trained Graph Neural Networks for Graph-level Tasks* (**ICDE 2024**).
- **Zhili Wang**, Shimin Di, Lei Chen. *A Message Passing Neural Network Space for Better Capturing Data-dependent Receptive Fields* (**SIGKDD 2023**).
- **Zhili Wang**, Shimin Di, Lei Chen. *AutoGEL: An Automated Graph Neural Network with Explicit Link Information* (**NeurIPS 2021**).
- Jialiang Wang, Hanmo Liu, Shimin Di, **Zhili Wang**, Jiachuan Wang, Lei Chen, Xiaofang Zhou *Proficient Graph Neural Network Design by Accumulating Knowledge on Large Language Models* (**WSDM 2026**).
- Hanmo Liu, Shimin Di, Jialiang Wang, **Zhili Wang**, Jiachuan Wang, Xiaofang Zhou, Lei Chen. *Structuring Benchmark into Knowledge Graphs to Assist Large Language Models in Retrieving and Designing Models* (**ICLR 2025**).
- Yubo Wang, Shimin Di, **Zhili Wang**, Haoyang Li, Fei Teng, Hao Xin, Lei Chen *Understanding the Embedding Models on Hyper-relational Knowledge Graph* (**CIKM 2025**).
- Jun Wang, Yunxiang Yao, Wenwei Kuang, Runze Mao, Zhenhao Sun, Zhuang Tao, Ziyang Zhang, Dengyu Li, Jiajun Chen, **Zhili Wang**, Kai Cui, Congzhi Cai, Longwen Lan, Ken Zhang. *OmniInfer: System-Wide Acceleration Techniques for Optimizing LLM Serving Throughput and Latency* (**Preprint**).

Researcher at Huawei, Hong Kong

LLM Inference Optimization — Aug. 2025 – Present

- Conducted research and algorithm designs for LLM KV-Cache, sparse attention, aiming at efficient LLM solutions.
- Contributed to the development of LLM serving framework *OmniInfer* on Huawei Ascend NPUs.

Quant Researcher Intern at Y-Intercept, Hong Kong

Full Lifecycle of Systematic Trading Strategy Research — Jan. 2025 – Jul. 2025

- **Earnings Announcement Prediction for Equities (US)**
  - Engineered fundamental features and trained tree-based models with prediction error-based position.
  - Achieved Sharpe > 1.3 and $MDD_r < 8\%$ [OOS for backtesting: 2022-present].
- **Intraday Strategy for FX (G10 & EM)**
  - Designed and pre-processed various intraday minute-level features (e.g., reversal-based, momentum-based, etc.).
  - Trained Transformer (for non-linearity and XA lead-lag) & LASSO models and conducted vol-adjusted position.
  - Achieved (pre-cost) overall Sharpe > 3.5, single-feature Sharpe > 1.5. Identified moderate signal correlation between <LASSO, Transformer> with up to 30% boost when combined [rolling OOS for backtesting: 2009-2020].
- **Cross-asset Momentum Spillover Strategy for Futures (EMEA)**
  - Designed cross-asset graph structure to capture momentum spillover effect for novel signals.
  - Boosted Sharpe from 0.8 to 1.3, reduced MDD_r from 6% to 3% over OLS [OOS for backtesting: 2020-present].

Skills Summary

- **Programmings:** Python, PyTorch
- **Personal Interests:** Strength Training, Culinary Arts